

Shivang Shelat

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Education

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SANTA BARBARA
PhD, MA Cognition, Perception, & Cognitive Neuroscience 2023 –
BS Psychological & Brain Sciences *with highest honors* 2019 – 2023

Selected Honors

Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation 2023 – 2026
Mayer Award for Outstanding Research Contribution, University of California, Santa Barbara 2025
Software of the Year Honorable Mention (Team Award), NASA 2025
National Eye Institute Early Career Scientist Travel Grant, Vision Sciences Society 2024
Ames Honor Award, NASA 2023
Morgan Award for Research Promise, University of California, Santa Barbara 2022
Presidential Scholarship Award, Teledyne Technologies 2019

Experience

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SANTA BARBARA
Graduate Research Fellow, Attention Lab & Memory, Emotion, Thought, Awareness Lab Sep. 2023 –
PIs: Dr. Barry Giesbrecht & Dr. Jonathan Schooler
Research Assistant, Media Neuroscience Lab Jan. 2021 – Aug. 2022
PI: Dr. Rene Weber
Lab Manager, Memory Emotion, Thought, Awareness Lab Mar. 2021 – Jun. 2022
PI: Dr. Jonathan Schooler
Research Assistant, Ashby Lab for Computational Cognitive Neuroscience Mar. 2020 – Mar. 2021
PI: Dr. Gregory Ashby
NASA AMES RESEARCH CENTER – SJSURF
Student Researcher, Human–Computer Interaction Group Jun. 2021 – Aug. 2023
PI: Dr. Jessica Marquez
Student Researcher, Increasingly Automated Air Cargo Operations Group Jun. 2020 – Sep. 2020
PI: Dr. Richard Mogford

Publications

13 total – 6 first, 1 co-first, 5 second, 1 third author
student mentees underlined, equal contributions marked by asterisk

Shelat, S., Marome, B., Lopez, C., Giesbrecht, B., & Schooler, J. W. (2026). The veil of distraction: Mind-wandering and memorability jointly shape visual recognition and recall. *Memory & Cognition*.

Marome, B.*, **Shelat, S.***, & Schooler, J. W. (2025). The phenomenology of encoding: Experience sampling reveals thoughts associated with the retention of visual and verbal materials. *Consciousness and Cognition*.

Shelat, S., Homer, K., Karasinski, J. A., & Marquez, J. J. (2025). Multidimensional usability assessment in spaceflight analog missions. *Human-Computer Interaction for Space Exploration, SpaceCHI 4.0*.

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (2025). Perceptual decoupling in the sustained attention to response task is likely: Comment on Bedi, Russell, & Helton (2024). *Experimental Brain Research*.

Garg, A., **Shelat, S.,** Gross, M. E., Smallwood, J., Seli, P., Taxali, A., Sripatha, C. S., & Schooler, J. W. (2025). Opening the black box: Think Aloud as a method to study the spontaneous stream of consciousness. *Consciousness and Cognition*.

Karasinski, J. A., **Shelat, S.**, & Marquez, J. J. (2025). Validation of self-scheduling countermeasures in NASA's HERA Campaign 6. *SciTech Forum*.

Garg, A., **Shelat, S.**, & Schooler, J. W. (2025). Now I feel like I'm going to get to it soon: A brief, scalable intervention for state procrastination. *BMC Psychology*.

Shelat, S., Marquez, J. J., Zheng, J., & Karasinski, J. A. (2024). Collaborative system usability in spaceflight analog environments through remote observations. *Applied Sciences*.

Shelat, S., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (2024). Predicting attentional lapses using response time speed in continuous performance tasks. *Frontiers in Cognition*.

Zheng, J., **Shelat, S.**, & Marquez, J. J. (2023). Facilitating crew-computer collaboration during mixed-initiative space mission planning. *Human-Computer Interaction for Space Exploration, SpaceCHI 3.0*.

Marquez, J. J., **Shelat, S.**, & Karasinski, J. A. (2022). Promoting crew autonomy in a human spaceflight Earth analog mission through self-scheduling. *Accelerating Space Commerce, Exploration, and New Discovery, ASCEND*.

Shelat, S., Karasinski, J. A., Flynn-Evans, E. E., & Marquez, J. J. (2022). Evaluation of user experience of self-scheduling software for astronauts: Defining a satisfaction baseline. *Engineering Psychology and Cognitive Ergonomics, Lecture Notes in Computer Science*.

Young, A., Robbins, I., & **Shelat, S.** (2022). From micro to macro: The combination of consciousness. *Frontiers in Psychology*.

IN PROGRESS

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (under revision). Value-driven attentional capture prevents commission errors in real time.

Shelat, S., & Schooler, J. W. (under review). The costs and benefits of mind-wandering: Thirteen years on.

Shelat, S., Clubb, A. R., Giesbrecht, B. *, & Schooler, J. W.* (submitted). Social desirability bias obscures mind-wandering reports.

Presentations

POSTERS

Shelat, S., Clubb, A. R., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (2025). Social desirability bias distorts self-reports of mind-wandering. In *Psychonomic Society's 66th Annual Meeting*.

Shelat, S., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (2025). Catching the wandering mind with real-time triggers. In *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*.

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (2024). Value-driven attentional capture in a continuous performance task with real-time triggering. In *Psychonomic Society's 65th Annual Meeting*.

Tzetzio, A. G., **Shelat, S.**, Schooler, J. W., & Protzko, J. (2024). Phantom hurdles. In *Psychonomic Society's 65th Annual Meeting*.

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (2024). Real-time prevention of response inhibition failures via value-driven attentional capture. In *Institute for Collaborative Technologies: Cognitive Neuroscience Workshop*.

Shelat, S., Marome, B., Giesbrecht, B., & Schooler, J. W. (2024). Mind-wandering during encoding impairs recognition for both forgettable and memorable complex scenes. In *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*.

Tzetzio, A. G., **Shelat, S.**, Schooler, J. W., & Protzko, J. (2024). Unfinished tasks turning into phantom hurdles. In *16th Annual Meeting of the Society for the Science of Motivation*.

TALKS

Shelat, S., Thayer, D. D., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (accepted). Deep mind-wandering amplifies attentional capture. In *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*.

Shelat, S. (2026). Spatial attention during mind-wandering. *Seminar on Cognition, Perception, & Cognitive Neuroscience, University of California, Santa Barbara*. [invited]

Shelat, S., Homer, K., Karasinski, J. A., & Marquez, J. J. (2025). Multidimensional usability assessment in spaceflight analog missions. *SpaceCHI 4.0, virtual*.

Shelat, S. (2025). Experience-dependent capture prevents attentional lapses in real time. *Annual Minicon, University of California, Santa Barbara*. [invited]

Marquez, J. J., Zheng, J., **Shelat, S.,** Karasinski, J. A., & Bresina, J. (2024). Crew autonomy through self-scheduling: Guidelines for crew scheduling performance envelope and mitigation strategies. *Human Research Program Investigators' Working Group Workshop*.

Shelat, S., Karasinski, J. A., Flynn-Evans, E. E., & Marquez, J. J. (2022). Evaluation of user experience of self-scheduling software for astronauts: Defining a satisfaction baseline. *International Conference on Human-Computer Interaction, virtual*.

Service, Mentoring, & Development

SERVICE

Undergraduate Experience Committee Representative	2025 –
member of a committee to manage student engagement initiatives and organize annual awards ceremonies	
Access Grads Mentor	2024 –
mentor for students interested in pursuing graduate school	
Invited Discussant – Seattle University Ethics Bowl	2026
consultant for an undergraduate ethics team on the feasibility of memory manipulation	
Fellowship & Grant Writing Panelist	2025
speaker for experiences with applications to funding sources	
NSF GRFP Advice Panelist	2025
speaker on how to write statements of purpose and research plans	

MENTORSHIP

Alexis Clubb	2024 –	Casey Lopez	2024 –
next: Assistant Director, Sage Center for the Study of the Mind		next: Quantitative methodology RA with Delwin Carter	
Brecken Marome	2023 – 2025		
next: PhD student with Dr. Ed Awh, University of Chicago			
Stanton Nowinski	2026 –	Charlie McGuinness	2025 –
Hiya Kaul	2024 – 2026	Lily Swank	2024 – 2026
Karina Mijangos Guzman	2023 – 2025	Patrick Sperling	2025
Avital Schwarz	2025	Brandon Tran	2024

TEACHING WORKSHOPS

Active Learning: What, Why, How?, University of California, Santa Barbara	2026
Developing Engaging Sections, University of California, Santa Barbara	2025
Creating Supportive Learning Environments, University of California, Santa Barbara	2025

REVIEWING (AD HOC)

Cognition and Emotion, Consciousness and Cognition, Proceedings of the Human Factors and Ergonomics Society

Media Coverage

”Lost in thought: How mind-wandering affects what we remember” – interview with *KCSB-FM 91.9* [↗](#)

"Even brief lapses in attention can weaken memory" – *The Current* [↗](#)

"Brief, scalable fix for overcoming state procrastination" – *Scienmag* [↗](#)

"A two-minute fix for procrastination" – *The Current* [↗](#)